done. There were no airs, no graces, no grand gestures. He has never shown out much. That's probably why we get on so well; we are similar in character.

It was a poignant occasion, on a number of levels. About a dozen of us were there; it was the first time in several years we had got together. Watching the film reminded us of the amazing experiences we had shared. Every player has his own story, but we all felt the power of the question, posed to Trotty in a subsequent question-and-answer session:

'Would you do it all again?'

'In a heartbeat.'

He broke down attempting to explain how he missed batting with the likes of Straussy, me and KP, but those three words summed everything up. We were so privileged to play for England. We were blessed to share such highs and lows. Life isn't perfect, but time lends perspective. We were united by more than what separated us.

Professional sport can take a forbidding toll. I would ask any fan, tempted to condemn a player who has failed as being 'useless' to watch a sequence in the film, in which Trotty is explaining his inner thoughts on getting out in Brisbane, where I'd seen him weeping in the dressing room. He was caught at deep square leg and the commentator was criticizing him for 'dumb cricket'.

Trotty had batted with tears in his eyes. He had a searing headache. His system had shut down. His mind was blown. He was not conscious of walking back towards the pavilion. His testimony was deeply personal, but relevant to us all. We are not robots. Other elements can creep into our game. The mental health of any performer is precious.

Years pass, careers come and go, but the team is a stake in the ground. It anchors us to our achievements, reconnects us with who we were, and why we were able to enjoy our moment in time. I was lucky to play with so many exceptional cricketers, but, ultimately, runs and wickets are not of paramount importance.

I've learned to go beyond the present, and cherish memories that will be a golden thread, running through the rest of our lives.